

Independent Academic Path Optimizer

User Manual

AI-Assisted Class Scheduling Application



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Version	Date	Description
v1.0.0	August 2026	Initial user manual for Sprint 2 Wiki Submission

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1. Introduction

This manual is intended for students and staff who are looking to use the Intelligent Academic Path Optimizer (IAPO) to plan out the next steps in one's education. The IAPO is a web application that allows a user to input information on one's educational journey and receive a path forward tailored to their interests. This may be useful to not only students, but advisors and administrators for an overarching view of the curriculum.

2. Device Requirements

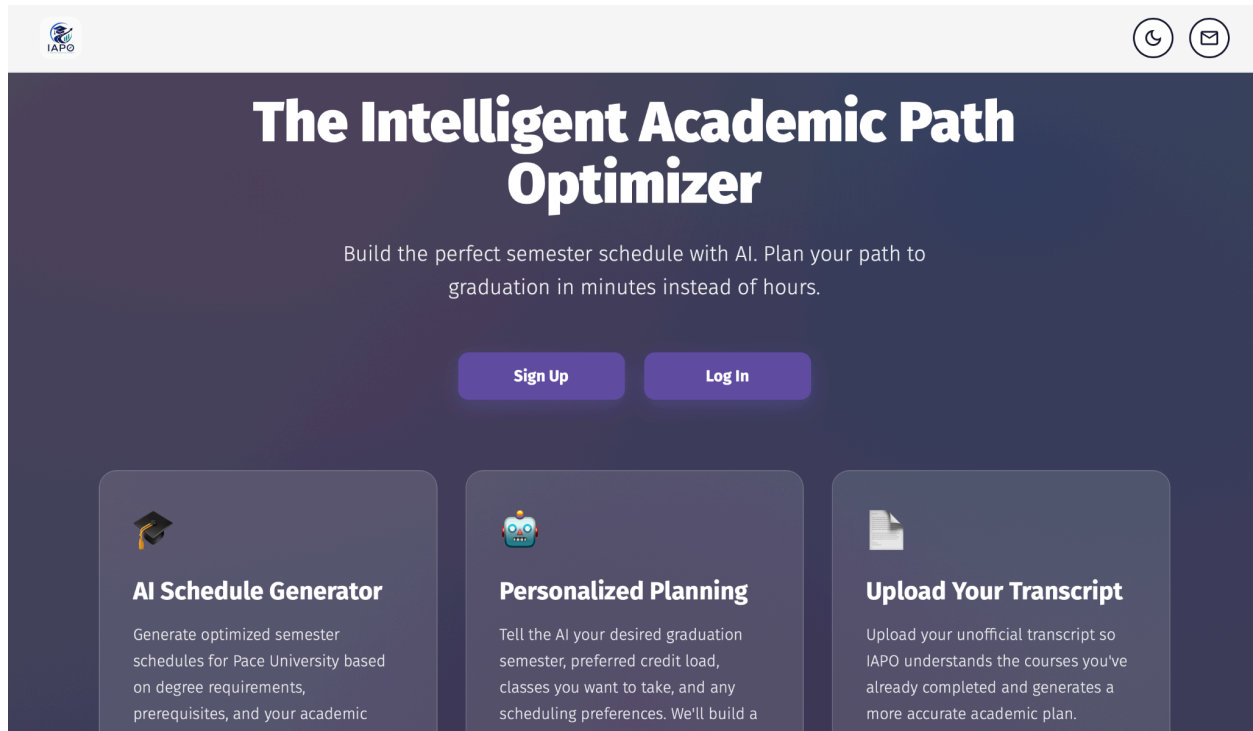
This application will run optimally on most up to date browsers such as Google Chrome, Safari, or Firefox. Additionally Cross-Site Traffic must be enabled on the browsers, allowing session login cookies to be saved. A personal computer is suggested for best rendering and ease of use. If submitting a transcript, conversion to a PDF is necessary. Many popular word processors will allow you to export your DOCX or PAGES file to a PDF.

3. Registering or Logging In

Begin by accessing the website via:

<https://2026-paceu-capstone.github.io/intelligent-academic-path-optimizer>.

You will see the home page with options to either sign up or log in, as follows:



If this is the first time using the site, proceed with the Sign Up button, otherwise click Log In.

Signing Up

To sign up, enter a valid email and strong password that is at least 8 characters and includes a capital letter, a number, and a special character.

Logging In

To log in, enter your email and password. Upon successful log in, the user will be taken back to the home page with access to their profile and schedule. Once logged in, the user may view the schedule page again at any time by clicking their initial in the top right of the screen.



At any point the user may click the IAPO logo next to it to navigate back to the home page.

Note:

Email and password may be edited later. See section 8 for more information.

4. Entering Your Data

To ensure a schedule is optimally created based on the user's needs, some information is required. The form will ask that the user fills out their:

- Name
- Educational level
- Major
- Beginning and ending semester
- Credit per semester desired

A screenshot of a web application interface titled "Let's Get Started". The form is set against a dark blue background with white text and input fields. At the top left is the IAPO logo, and at the top right are icons for a clock and an envelope. The form contains the following sections:

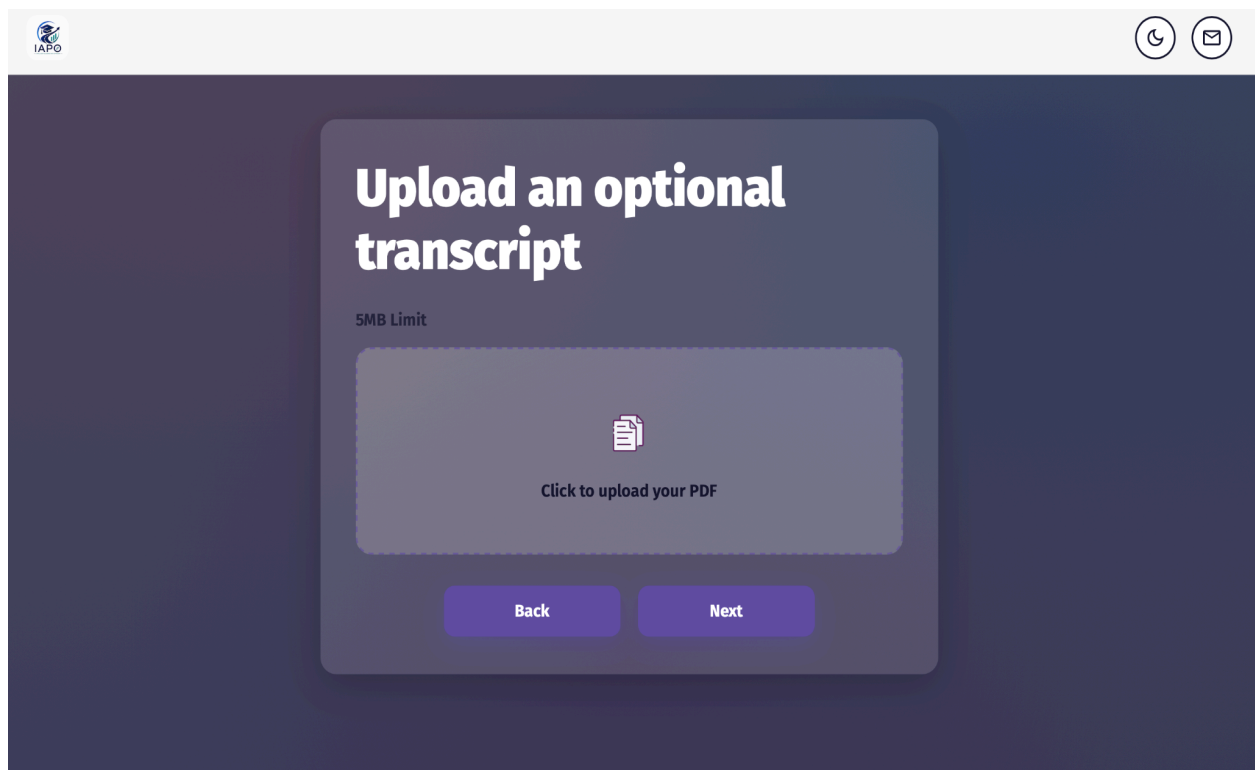
- What's your name?**: A text input field with the placeholder "Your Name".
- Degree Level**: Two radio button options, "Undergrad" (which is selected and highlighted in purple) and "Graduate".
- What's your major?**: A dropdown menu with "Select" as the current selection.
- Starting Semester** and **Ending Semester**: Two dropdown menus, both with "Select" as the current selection.
- How many credits per semester**: A text input field with the placeholder "Max 18 credits".

At the bottom of the form is a purple button labeled "Next".

Click Next to proceed with profile creation.

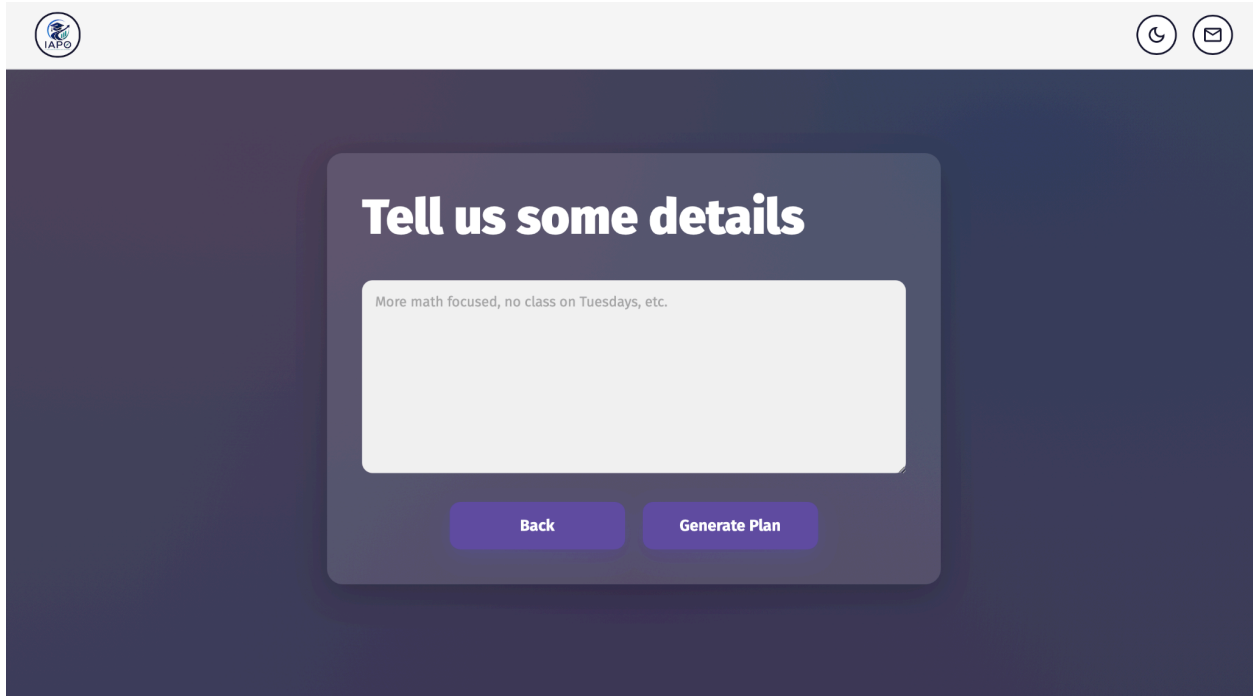
5. Uploading Your Transcript

IAPO provides the option to upload an academic transcript for a more personalized schedule. If this does not apply, click Next to proceed to the following section. Otherwise, clicking the light grey upload area of the screen will open a window displaying files available on the current machine. Navigate to the desired PDF and press Upload. IAPO will then check the PDF and ensure that it is a proper transcript. Once successfully uploaded, click Next on the webpage to proceed with telling IAPO your goal.



6. Specify What You're Looking For

The page labelled “Tell us some details” allows the user to directly inform the AI of specific characteristics they wish for their schedule to have. For example, “No gaming courses in the Fall” would be appropriately processed and the expected course plan would be output. When finished, click Generate Plan and you will briefly wait at a loading screen while the schedule is created.



IAPO

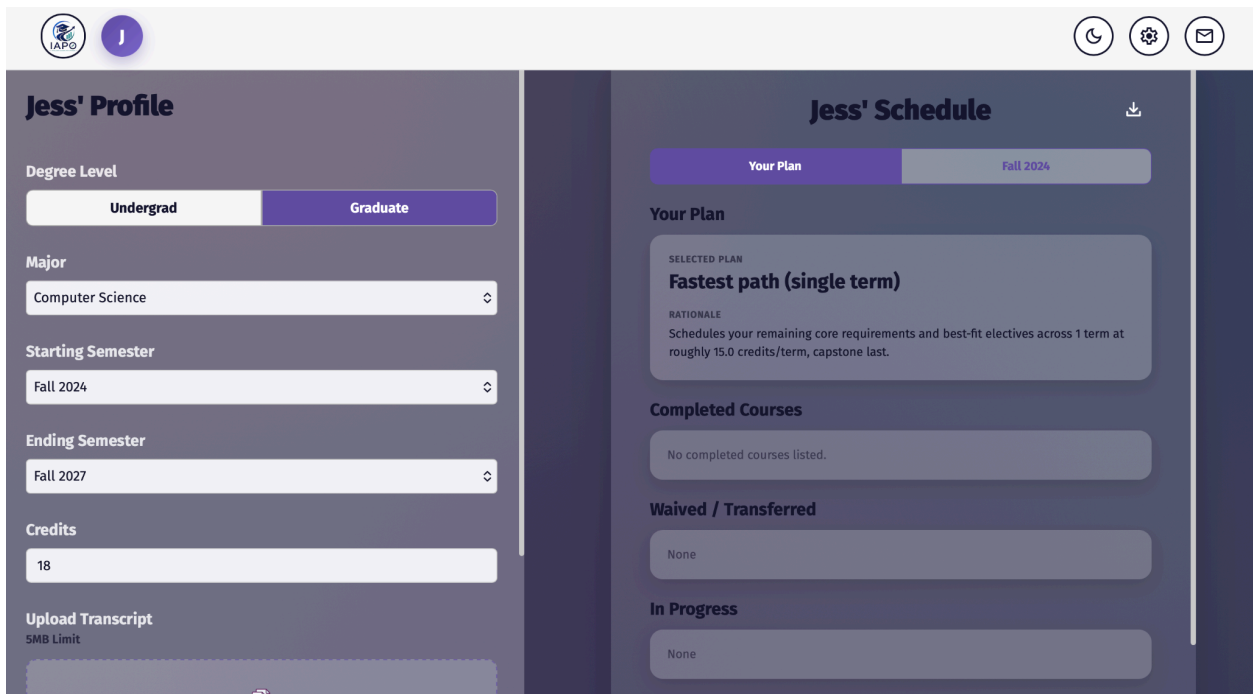
Tell us some details

More math focused, no class on Tuesdays, etc.

Back Generate Plan

7. Schedule Page

A page similar to the following will be shown.



IAPO J

Jess' Profile

Degree Level

Undergrad Graduate

Major

Computer Science

Starting Semester

Fall 2024

Ending Semester

Fall 2027

Credits

18

Upload Transcript
5MB Limit

Jess' Schedule

Your Plan Fall 2024

Your Plan

SELECTED PLAN

Fastest path (single term)

RATIONALE

Schedules your remaining core requirements and best-fit electives across 1 term at roughly 15.0 credits/term, capstone last.

Completed Courses

No completed courses listed.

Waived / Transferred

None

In Progress

None

On the left, there is a section similar to the information providing screen in which the user may edit their profile, upload a new transcript, or ask the AI to make changes to the current schedule. Clicking Next at the bottom of this section will generate a new schedule.

The right side of the screen presents the generated schedule with the following sections:

Tabs

The first tab displays the overarching plan information and subsequent tabs display the classes chosen for the corresponding semester.

Your Plan Tab

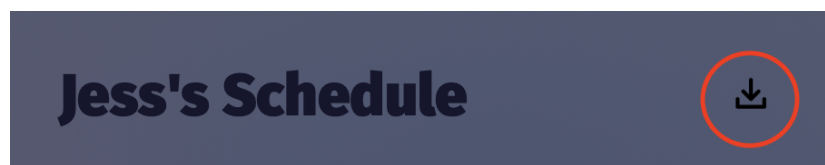
- Gives an overview of the plan's focus, reasoning on how the schedule was chosen, and goals that would be reached with the schedule.
- Optionally, if a transcript was uploaded, the user's previously completed, waived/transferred, and current semester courses will be displayed.
- Additional notes on schedule generation may be listed

Semester Tab

These tabs will display the suggested classes for that semester. The top right will show the total credits for that semester. Each class will thereunder be displayed with its amount of credits, course code, and why it was chosen.

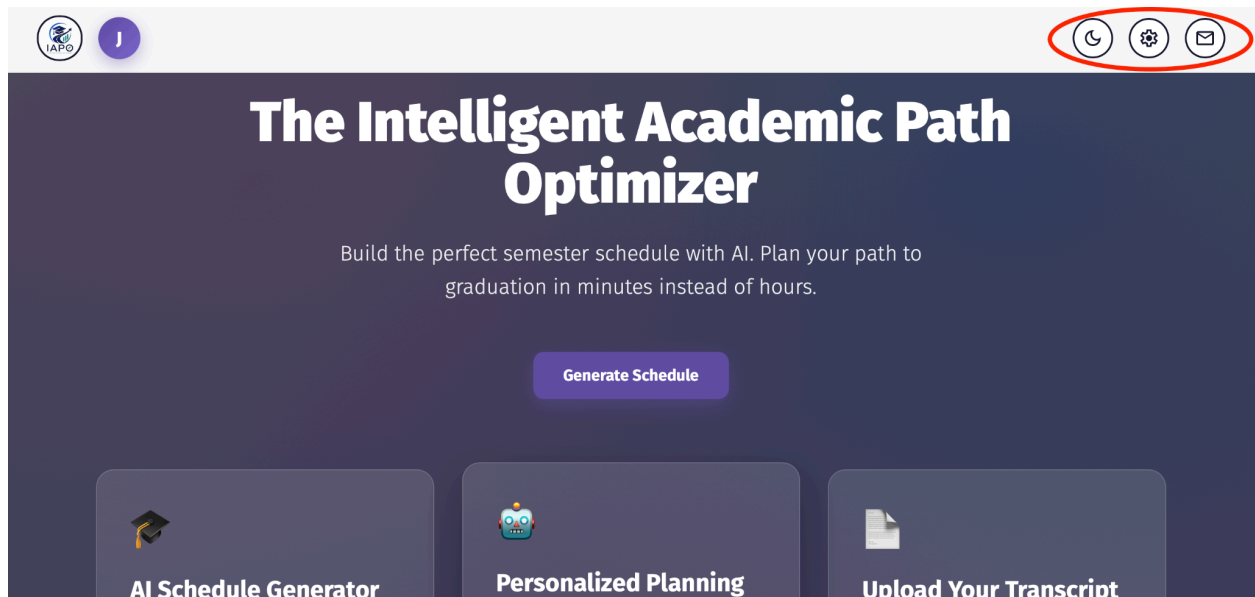
Download Button

The icon at the top right of the schedule portion gives the option to download the user's schedule, as seen below.



8. Settings Page

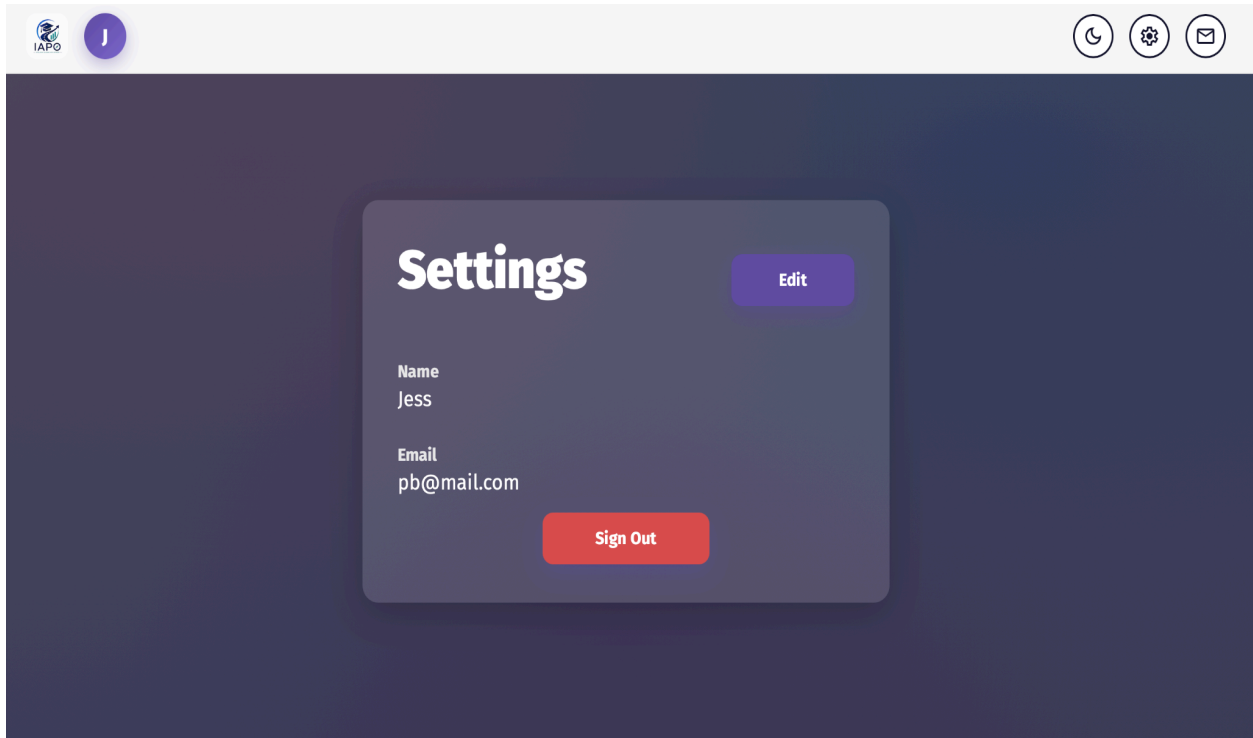
The top right of each page displays several buttons.



The gear icon will navigate the user to the settings page where they may change their name, email, and password respectively. This is also where the user may go to sign out, using the red button at the bottom of the page.



Pressing the Edit button at the top right of the Settings card will switch the user to an editing mode where they may make these changes. Pressing the Save button at the top right will enact these changes.



9. Light and Dark Mode

The final button, which shows a moon, allows the user to toggle between light and dark mode.



10. Contact Page

One of the buttons at the top right of each page is also a button depicting a letter. Clicking this will navigate the user to the Contact Page. This can be accessed regardless of if a user is logged in or not.



The user's name and email will be automatically filled in when logged in. The message section can be filled out and clicking Send Message will provide an email directly to the team with this message.

